

Faster / simpler  $\rightarrow$

**Helmholtz  
Wave Equation**

$$[\nabla^2 + k_0^2 n^2(\mathbf{r})] u(\mathbf{r}) = 0$$

*Reference full-  
wave formulation*

**Full KG ODE**

$$\partial_z^2 \psi + (\nabla_\perp^2 + k_0^2 n^2(\mathbf{r})) \psi = 0$$

*Adaptive second-order  
non-paraxial solve*

**KG Forward  
Solver (Krylov)**

$$\psi(z+\Delta z) \approx \exp(i\Delta z \sqrt{M}) \psi(z)$$

*Forward-wave square-  
root KG propagator  
via Lanczos projection*

**WPM (Wide-  
angle, local  $n$ )**

$$u(z + \Delta z) = \mathcal{F}^{-1} \left[ e^{ik_z^{(m)} \Delta z} \mathcal{F}\{u(z)\} \right]$$

$$k_z^{(m)} = \sqrt{(k_0 n_m)^2 - k_x^2 - k_y^2}$$

*Wide-angle split-step with  
local refractive index*

**Angular Spectrum  
(Non-Paraxial)**

$$u(z + \Delta z) = \mathcal{F}^{-1} \left[ e^{ik_z \Delta z} \mathcal{F}\{u(z)\} \right]$$

$$k_z = \sqrt{k^2 - k_x^2 - k_y^2}$$

*Wide-angle split-  
step in free space*

**Fresnel (Paraxial)**

$$u(z + \Delta z) = \mathcal{F}^{-1} \left[ e^{-i\pi \lambda \Delta z k_\perp^2} \mathcal{F}\{u(z)\} \right]$$

$$k_\perp^2 = k_x^2 + k_y^2$$

*Paraxial split-  
step in free space*

$\rightarrow$   
separate transverse and  
longitudinal dependence  
obtain a second-order  
evolution equation in  $z$

$\rightarrow$   
factor into forward and  
backward branches  
keep the forward  
solution:  $\partial_z \psi = i\sqrt{M} \psi$

$\leftrightarrow$   
same forward  
square-root operator  
Krylov projection versus  
local- $n$  spectral stepping

$\rightarrow$   
take the homogeneous-  
slice limit  
replace local index bins  
by  $n(x, y) = \text{const.}$

$\rightarrow$   
apply the small-angle  
Taylor expansion  
 $k_z \approx k_0 - k_\perp^2 / (2k_0)$

$\leftarrow$  More accurate / more general